

THE COGNAC STRATEGIC CONCLAVE



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PROCEDURAL GUIDE

Rules of Procedure

All committees at Model United Nations conferences are governed and dictated by a well-defined set of regulations. This section aims to introduce the aforementioned and delegates are requested to read it thoroughly.

Roll Call

The committee proceedings begin with a roll call. During the roll call, the Executive Board calls out the names of all portfolios in alphabetical order and the delegates may respond in the following ways:

(i) **Present** - When delegates respond with 'present', they are given the option to abstain, i.e., neither vote in favour nor vote against a document in substantive voting. Substantive voting relates to voting for draft resolutions, amendments, inter alia.

(ii) **Present and voting** - When delegates respond with 'present and voting', they are required to either vote for or against a document in substantive voting. They are not given the option of abstention. It is important to note that all delegates are required to vote for procedural matters such as passing a motion for a moderated caucus, passing a motion for an unmoderated caucus, inter alia. No abstention is permitted in procedural votes.

Motions

Motions are raised by a delegate in order to lead the committee in a specific direction. They can only be raised when the Executive Board has opened the floor for motions.

The general format for any motion is: "I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise a {Type of Motion}"

For example, "I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise a motion to enter formal debate and open the General Speakers' List with 90 seconds as the per speaker time."

The following are the types of motions that will be used in committee:

a) Motion to Open Debate

This motion is raised to commence debate in the committee. It is raised at the beginning of the first committee session on the first day of the conference. This motion is mandatory for debate to take place.

How to raise this motion: "I, {Portfolio} would like to raise a motion to open debate."

b) Motion to Open the General Speakers' List

This motion is used when a delegate wishes to open the General Speakers' List, and hence commence formal debate. There is no total time for a GSL, as the GSL is inexhaustible and will be reverted back to should all other motions fail. This motion can only be raised once, at the beginning of the conference.

How to raise this motion: "I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise a motion to enter formal debate and open the General Speakers' List."

c) Motion for a Moderated Caucus

This motion is used when the committee wants to discuss specific subtopics of an agenda.

While raising this motion, the topic, total time and individual speaker's time must be mentioned. It is important to note that the total time of a moderated caucus must be divisible by the per speaker's time so as to incorporate a whole number of speakers before the moderated caucus elapses. The maximum total time it can be raised for is 20 minutes.

How to raise this motion: "I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise a motion for a moderated caucus on the topic 'ABC' for the total time being 15 minutes and the individual speaker's time being 60 seconds."

d) Motion for an Unmoderated Caucus

During the first few committee sessions, unmoderated caucuses are used to build blocs, converse with other delegates, and discuss potential moderated caucus topics, while in the last few committee sessions they are primarily used for completing documentation. Just like moderated caucuses, the maximum time an unmoderated caucus can be raised for is 20 minutes. However, unmoderated caucuses do not have a topic or an individual speaker's time.

How to raise this motion: "I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise a motion for an unmoderated caucus for the total time of 10 minutes."

e) Motion for Extension

This motion is used to extend a moderated or unmoderated caucus. It must be kept in mind that they can only be extended by half the original time they were raised for. For instance, if an unmoderated caucus was originally raised for 10 minutes, then it can only be extended by 5 minutes.

How to raise this motion: "I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise a motion to extend the moderated/unmoderated caucus by a total time of 5 minutes."

f) Motion to open a Provisional Speakers' List (PSL)

The motion to open a PSL is generally used for debate when the committee is in crisis or do discuss documentation. Whilst raising this motion, delegates need to specify the topic, the total time and the individual speaker's time.

How to raise this motion: I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise a motion to open a Provisional Speakers' List on the topic 'ABC' for the total time being 10 minutes and the individual speaker's time being 60 seconds."

g) Motion to Introduce a Draft Resolution

This motion is raised to introduce documentation to the committee, which is a prerequisite for the document to be discussed. The name of the draft resolution is to be specified while introducing the document to the committee.

How to raise this motion: I, {Portfolio} would like to raise a motion to introduce Draft Resolution {name} to the committee.

h) Motion to Discuss a Draft Resolution

This motion is used to discuss a Draft Resolution. Delegates may point out loopholes, suggest modifications, and bring up features they feel are relevant while discussing a document to make it more comprehensive, effective and implementable. The authors and the sponsors for a draft resolution are answerable to the committee regarding the content of their documentation. When raising this motion, the delegates are required to mention how they want the documentation to be discussed. Documentation is primarily discussed via the following methods:

- A clause-by-clause discussion is when each and every clause of the document is discussed thoroughly. Delegates can question the authors or sponsors of the document after every clause.
- A moderated caucus discussion enables the delegates to raise concerns and question the authors or sponsors of the document in their speeches. There is no direct question and answer session in this form of discussion.
- A provisional speakers' list allows delegates to talk about the document in their speeches, and if they have time left, they may yield it.

How to raise this motion: I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise a motion to discuss Draft Resolution {name} through a moderated caucus/clause-by-clause discussion/provisional speakers list of total time 15 minutes and individual speaker's time 1 minute.

i) Motion to Move into Amendment Procedure for a Draft Resolution

After the discussion of a draft resolution, delegates may choose to move into amendment procedure to suggest addition, modification or deletion of clauses. They can suggest changes by sending amendment chits to the Executive Board. When the amendments are introduced, the sponsors of the draft resolution may deem them friendly or unfriendly by consensus.

- A friendly amendment does not need to be voted upon and is directly incorporated into the resolution
- An unfriendly amendment has to be voted upon and needs to obtain the votes of a special majority of at least 2/3rds of the strength of the committee to be incorporated into the draft resolution.

How to raise this motion: I, {Portfolio}, would like to move into amendment procedure for Draft Resolution {name}.

j) Motion to Close Debate and Move into Voting Procedure for a Draft Resolution

This motion is raised to move into the voting procedure for a draft resolution. A draft resolution requires a special majority comprising 2/3rds of the committee strength in order to pass. Once a draft resolution passes, it is adopted and considered the final document of the committee representing the conclusion it has come to. It is important to note that once a draft resolution passes, voting will not be conducted for any other resolutions. The voting for a resolution is done through a roll call vote. In a roll call vote, the Executive Board calls out the names of delegates present in the committee in alphabetical order and the delegates may respond with yes, no, yes with rights or no with rights.

- Delegates may respond with a yes to vote in favour of the draft resolution,
- Delegates may respond with a no to vote against the draft resolution,
- Delegates may respond with an abstain if they wish to neither vote in favour of nor vote against the resolution. However, delegates can only abstain if they responded with 'Present' and not 'Present and Voting' during their roll call.
- Delegates may respond with yes/no with rights when they vote in favour of or against a resolution and wish to give reasons for the same. They are then given a 30 second comment after voting for all delegates is complete.

How to raise this motion: I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise a motion to move into voting procedure for Draft Resolution {name} through a roll call vote.

k) Motion to Recess

This motion is used to temporarily suspend debate at the end of each committee session.

How to raise this motion: I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise the motion for committee to recess.

l) Motion to Adjourn

This motion is raised on the last day of the conference to conclude committee proceedings.

How to raise this motion: I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise the motion to adjourn committee.

Points

Through points, delegates can ask a question in the committee, clarify their queries, point out procedural errors, inter alia. The directors will regularly open up the floor for points to be raised. The general format for any point is: “I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise a point of {Type of Point}.”

Points can be categorised as follows:

a) Point of Personal Privilege

This point is used when a delegate experiences personal discomfort or inconvenience that hinders their ability to participate in committee. This is the only point which delegates can raise whilst another delegate has the floor in committee.

For example, this point can be used if the delegate wants the Executive Board or a fellow delegate to repeat anything.

The format for a point of personal privilege: “I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise a point of personal privilege.”

b) Point of Parliamentary Inquiry

This point is used when a delegate needs clarification regarding committee procedure.

For example, this point can be used if a delegate has a question regarding yields.

The format for a point of parliamentary inquiry: “I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise a point of parliamentary inquiry.”

c) Point of Information

This point is used when a delegate wishes to ask another delegate a question after they complete their speech or at any point in committee. Verbal points of information will only be entertained during formal debate if the delegate yields to POIs. If a delegate wishes to ask a POI after a moderated caucus speech, they may do so through a chit via the Executive Board.

For example, this point can be used to question logical fallacies in a delegate’s speech.

The format for a point of information: “I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise a point of information.”

d) Point of Order

This point is used when an error has been committed in the rules of procedure by the Executive Board.

For example, this point can be used if roll call is taken before establishment of formal committee.

The format for a point of order: “I, {Portfolio}, would like to raise a point of order.”

e) Right to Reply

A right to reply is used by a delegate to comment or reply when they feel their integrity has been compromised due to personal allegations, insults, or comments made about them. If a Right to Reply is granted, then the delegate will be allowed to speak immediately, outside the list of speakers.

Yields

Yields are used when a delegate has time remaining after their speech in formal methods of debate. The delegate may relinquish or allocate the excess time in the following ways:

1. Yield to the Chair - When a delegate yields to the Chair, their remaining time is dissolved with the committee time.
2. Yield to Points of Information (POIs)- When a delegate yields to points of information, other delegates may ask them questions based on their speech. The number of POIs recognised by the chair will depend on the time remaining from the speech.
3. Yield to Another Delegate- When a delegate yields their time to another delegate, the delegate to whom the remaining time is yielded may comment on the original speech given or further build up on it. Delegates are to confer with each other and obtain prior permission before yielding their time to another delegate.
4. Yield to Comments- When a delegate yields to comments, speakers are recognised to make comments regarding the speech for the remaining time.

Delegates are to note that they are not required to yield their time in informal methods of debate.

Forms of Debate

The forms of debate are broadly classified into 2 categories:

1. Formal Debate - Discussion in formal debate can be done through the General Speakers' List and the Provisional Speakers' List.
2. Informal Debate - Discussion in informal debate can be done via moderated caucuses, unmoderated caucuses and open floors.

Formal Debate

Formal debate is the standard form of constructive debate in committee. In formal debate, delegates are expected to outline their stances, highlight problems, suggest solutions and formulate plans. Speeches must be diplomatic, well-structured and coherent. Delegates must use parliamentary language and be respectful at all times.

Discussion in formal debate can be done through the General Speakers' List, Provisional Speakers' List, and Round Robins. How to raise motions to enter the same is described in the 'Motions' section.

(a) General Speakers' List (GSL)

In a GSL, each delegate, by default, gets 90 seconds to speak. However, delegates may choose to amend this time if they feel necessary. If a delegate finishes their speech before the allotted time, they are required to yield it, as explained earlier. There is no topic for a GSL and delegates may use it to discuss whatever they feel is relevant. They can use it to give an introduction to the agenda, present their stance, highlight problems, inter alia. The GSL is an inexhaustible list and remains open throughout the conference.

(b) Provisional Speakers' List (PSL)

A PSL differs from a GSL as it is conducted on a specific topic and is not inexhaustible. PSLs are generally used to discuss crisis updates or contentious subtopics of the agenda. The total time of the list, along with individual speaker's time, must be specified. The raiser of the motion may choose to speak first or last. In case delegates finish their speeches before their time has elapsed, they are required to yield the remaining time.

(c) Round Robin

In a Round Robin, it is mandatory for all delegates to speak. Not unlike moderated caucuses, they have a prescribed time (typically 30/45 seconds per speaker) and a specific subtopic. There

are no yields in a Round Robin. It is a helpful way to get the opinions of all the delegates present. This is a more disruptive form of debate than other forms of formal debate.

Informal Debate

Discussion in informal debate can be done via moderated and unmoderated caucuses.

(a) Moderated Caucus

Moderated caucuses are of the utmost importance in a committee as they enable delegates to streamline debate. This allows delegates to debate upon a specific subtopic of the agenda within the prescribed time. Moderated caucuses generally do not allow for yields, but procedure can be amended to allow yields if it would help in having constructive debate.

(b) Unmoderated Caucus

Unmoderated caucuses are a form of informal debate where the delegates are allowed to speak directly to each other without moderation from the executive board. Unmoderated caucuses are used to discuss potential moderated caucus topics, to complete documentation, as well as for lobbying and building blocs. Please note that all delegates must remain respectful and diplomatic during unmoderated caucuses and use only parliamentary language.

(c) Open Floor

Open floors are the most disruptive form of debate. The open floor debate format allows any delegate to raise their placard and speak when recognized by the chair. Unlike a moderated caucus, there is no per speaker time but only a time limit for the entire open floor. It encourages spontaneous, interactive discussion, letting delegates directly address points or respond to others.

Paperwork Guidelines

A semi-crisis committee is one based on taking tangible action against various crises that arise in the committee. Thus given the unique nature of the committee, it is no surprise that it possesses a unique system that allows delegates to take action.

In this committee, the main way of taking action, carrying out any operation or making some announcement to the public will be through Communiques and Press Releases. This section of the background guide will serve as a guide to writing these documents.

Communiqués

A communiqué is a message that can be sent by a delegate to the government of their country or any person of their choice, as long as the recipient isn't a member of the committee. In Semi Crisis committees, a communiqué issues an instruction or a set of instructions that a delegate wishes the recipient of the message to carry out. Communiques in this committee will be of two types: private and public, both of which can be sent alone or as "joint" communiques, in collaboration with other delegates.

A private communiqué will be kept secret and will not be revealed to the Committee. In order for a public communiqué to be enacted, it will be voted upon by the members of the committee. The note must be headed by the word "communiqué" followed by whether it is a Private/Public communiqué. The body of the message must clearly outline the actions they wish to perform; the executive board should be able to easily discern the "Who, What, When, Where, and How."

The delegates must understand that simply sending a communiqué to the directors does not mean that your action has been approved; it is up to the discretion of the chair to pass or reject your communiqué, depending on whether they think it is appropriate or consequential to the direction that the committee is taking.

A communiqué, unlike directives, does not have to be written in the UN resolution format and can be written in simple English, meaning that you do not have to use clauses. Delegates are advised to send communiqués to deal with internal crises in their own nations in ways that they believe would affect the proceedings of the committee and to even carry out any secret investigative work.

They can further use them to increase their own social, economic or political power, or bring down their adversaries in the committee itself. There is no need to send a communiqué regarding a topic that has no bearings on committee proceedings.

Sample Communiqué:

PRIVATE/PUBLIC COMMUNIQUE To: ABC From: XYZ Body (must mention Who, What, When, Where and How)
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Press Release

This can be used by a delegate, or a group of delegates, to inform the public about certain facts or to make some announcements about any policy changes. The delegates can also use this as a tool to spread misinformation about any ongoing crisis. One of the most important uses of a “Press Release” is to try and influence public opinion and win their support.

Format for a Press Release:

Press Release An appropriate Title/Heading for the Statement Body of the statement Signatures: XYZ ABC

Chits

Chits are short written notes that are usually used to establish communication with another delegate or with the Executive Board. They do not require strict formatting as a communique would. They cannot be used to take action. Do note that while they may be informal in nature, the usage of unparliamentary language in chits will not be tolerated. There are four main types of chits:

a) Informal chit to the EB

These are used to establish communications with the members of the Executive Board without disrupting the overall flow of the committee. They can be used to raise doubts that would otherwise be a Point of Parliamentary Enquiry or Personal Privilege, such as requests to move the delegate's name up/down on a speaker's list, asking for clarification regarding documentation, procedural doubts etc.

The basic format for these chits are:

To: The Executive Board From: [Sender's Portfolio] [body]

b) Informal chit to another delegate

These chits will not be marked or seen by the EB and can be used to speak directly to other delegates while the committee is in formal session. Informal chits to other delegates are highly important for lobbying purposes, and thus the language used in them should be diplomatic. These chits could be used to ask delegates to join blocs, clarify their stances, ask for assistance etc.

The format for these chits are:

To: [Receiver's Portfolio] From: [Sender's Portfolio] [body]
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c) Chit via the Executive Board

Chits via the Executive Board are used when a delegate wishes for the Executive Board to take note of communications between delegates. They can be used to ask delegates points of information regarding their speeches, documentations etc. Replies to points of information can also be sent as chits via the Executive Board.

The format for these is:

To: [Receiver's Portfolio] (VIA THE EB) From: [Sender's Portfolio] [body]

d) Substantive chits

Substantive chits are chits which are intended to contribute to debate in the committee. These should only be used when a delegate is unable to convey their points in a speech due to a lack of time, or wishes to clarify a point made by them. Substantive chits must be concise and to the point, and not exceed 80 words. These chits are to be addressed to the Executive Board and will be marked.

The format for these is:

Substantive Chit To: The Executive Board From: [Sender's Portfolio] [body]

Position Paper

Position papers offer the members an opportunity to present their portfolio's opinions and ideologies with regard to the subject under discussion. Keep in mind the following while preparing your position paper:

- An ideal position paper starts with a brief introduction to the subject in your words, and how you think the history of your portfolio is with reference to the same (usually covered in the first paragraph).
- As you proceed, elucidate on the stance you will take in committee, according to your portfolio, and the goals and aims you wish to achieve through committee. Bring out the flaws and lacunas in the legal framework and establish the problems present.
- Delegates to please note, the Executive Board highly looks upon mentioning the **crisis arcs** and **plans of action** you wish to implement in committee in your position paper.
- Thereafter, bring out the policies and reforms you wish to introduce with regard to the same.
- Make sure your solutions are well thought out and make sense, considering the political and social environment of the region. Note that your solutions are a crucial part of your paper, and cannot be omitted. They, in addition to your stance, form the foundation for the subsequent action that you wish to take in committee.
- Feel free to criticise any actions of the government or public body but keep in mind that there is a word limit. Keep it short and crisp. The ideal length for a position paper is **1.5-2 pages**, not including citations and the bibliography.
- Avoid beating around the bush and keep the arguments to the point. We would encourage **underlining or highlighting the keywords**.
- Do not forget to include citations and a bibliography. Citing the sources utilised is important. Note that your citations are not included in the word limit (including both in-text and MLA citations).

→ Proofread your position paper before you submit it to avoid any grammatical errors and ambiguity.

Position papers should:

- 1) Include the name of the member, his/her portfolio and the committee name.
- 2) Be in a standard font (EB Garamond) with 12 point font size and 1-inch document margins.
- 3) Be in **PDF** format otherwise the submission will not be considered.
- 4) Include citations and a bibliography, in any format, giving due credit to the sources used for research (not included in the 1.5-2 page limit)

The deadline for submitting your position papers is **11:59 PM on 18th April**. They must be mailed to the committee email ID: csc2026.smun@gmail.com as a PDF document.

Final Documentation

The three days of debate are ultimately directed towards reaching a consensus and forming a resolution, known as the Draft Resolution (DR), that sets out how the delegates must tackle the various issues of the agenda.

A good Draft Resolution requires a well-rounded approach to the agenda and must be supported with a realistic framework for implementation. The Executive Board expects the Draft Resolution to be a comprehensive and formal document that is focused on solutions.

The Preamble of a Draft Resolution states the purpose of addressing the agenda at hand and highlights past international action on the issue. Each clause begins with a present participle, called a preambulatory phrase which is italicised, and the clause always ends with a comma.

Some sample preambulatory clauses include:

Affirming	Expecting	Noting with regret
Alarmed by	Expressing its appreciation	Noting with deep concern
Approving	Expressing its satisfaction	Noting with satisfaction
Bearing in mind	Fulfilling	Noting further
Believing	Fully alarmed	Noting with approval
Confident	Fully believing	Observing
Contemplating	Further desiring	Reaffirming
Convinced	Further recalling	Realising
Deeply concerned	Guided by	Recalling
Deeply conscious	Having adopted	Recognizing
Deeply convinced	Having considered	Referring
Deeply disturbed	Having examined	Seeking
Deeply regretting	Having Received	Taking into consideration

Desiring	Having studied	Taking note
Emphasising	Keeping in mind	Viewing with appreciation

Operative clauses are meant to offer solutions to issues addressed during the procession of the committee. These clauses are action-oriented and should include an underlined verb at the beginning of the sentence followed by the proposed solution.

Each clause should follow the following principles:

1. Clauses must be numbered;
2. Each clause should support another and continue to build your solution;
3. Add details to your clauses in order to have a complete solution;
4. Operative clauses must be punctuated by a semicolon, with the exception of the last operative clause which should end with a period.

Some sample operative phrases include:

Accepts	Draws the attention	Notes
Affirms	Emphasises	Reaffirms
Approves	Encourages	Recommends
Authorises	Endorses	Regrets
Calls	Expresses its hope	Reminds
Calls upon	Further invites	Requests
Condemns	Further proclaims	Strongly condemns
Confirms	Further reminds	Supports
Considers	Further recommends	Takes note of
Declares accordingly	Further requests	Transmits
Designates	Further resolves	Welcomes